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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 46138.77 ▲ 47.03 0.10%

NASDAQ 22564.23 ▲ 0.6%

STOXX 600 561.71 ▼ 0.03%

10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 3/32, yield 4.132%

OIL \$59.44 ▼ \$1.30

GOLD \$4,077.70 ▲ \$16.40

EURO \$1.1539

YEN 157.15

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Nvidia reported record** sales and strong guidance, helping soothe the jitters about an artificial intelligence bubble that have reverberated in markets for the past week. **A1**
◆ **The S&P 500 rose 0.4%**, snapping a four-day losing streak, while the Dow and Nasdaq gained 0.1% and 0.6%, respectively. **B8**

◆ **Target's incoming CEO** said it would invest about \$1 billion more next year on upgrades, bringing the total new investment to \$5 billion. **B1**

◆ **AIG pulled John Neal's** appointment as the insurer's second-in-command after it discovered his previous employer launched an investigation into an alleged workplace affair, according to people familiar with the matter. **B1**

◆ **Musk's AI company xAI** will work with chip maker Nvidia and a Saudi Arabian partner to develop a giant data center in the kingdom. **B1**

◆ **Major League Baseball** has completed new three-year media-rights agreements with ESPN, NBCUniversal and Netflix, the league announced. **B1**

◆ **McKinsey named** one of its smallest classes of partners in recent years, elevating 224 people, according to an internal note viewed by The Wall Street Journal. **B3**

◆ **Adobe struck** a \$1.9 billion deal to acquire Semrush, a software platform that helps businesses run better search-engine optimization as reliance on AI grows. **B3**

◆ **Divisions over whether** the Fed should cut interest rates next month deepened at officials' October meeting. **A2**

World-Wide

◆ **The Trump administration** has drafted a peace plan that calls for Ukraine to make major territorial concessions to Russia and drop demands for a peacekeeping force to deter future attacks by Moscow, resurfacing ideas that Kyiv has already rejected. **A1**
◆ **Ukraine used** U.S.-supplied long-range missiles to strike Russian territory, the first time it has acknowledged deploying the systems since Trump lifted restrictions on their use. **A8**

◆ **Trump signed legislation** authorizing the Justice Department to release files related to Jeffrey Epstein, giving Attorney General Pam Bondi 30 days to make available unclassified documents related to the sex offender. **A3**

◆ **Larry Summers won't** finish out the semester teaching at Harvard, after the release of correspondence between him and Epstein. **A3**

◆ **Trump said he will** meet with Zohran Mamdani on Friday at the New York mayor-elect's request. **A3**

◆ **The Justice Department** acknowledged that a full grand jury never reviewed the final indictment of former FBI Director James Comey, a concession that could further jeopardize the case. **A3**

◆ **A U.S. court** has, for now, blocked a rule in California requiring companies to divulge how changes in the climate put their business at risk. **A6**

◆ **Israel asked** the ICC to throw out an arrest warrant against Netanyahu and disqualify the chief prosecutor because of sexual assault allegations he faced at the time he sought the warrant. **A7**

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Leaders' Summit Sets Stage for Saudi AI Push



EXECUTIVE ACTION: Meeting Wednesday in Washington with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman and President Trump, front, Elon Musk and Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang, center, announced plans to develop a giant AI data center in Saudi Arabia. **B1, A4**

Trump Administration Pushes New Plan to End Ukraine War

Kyiv will likely oppose 28-point proposal containing demands it previously rejected

WASHINGTON—The Trump administration has drafted a 28-point peace plan that calls for Ukraine to make major territorial concessions to Russia and drop demands for a peacekeeping force to deter

By Alexander Ward,
Laurence Norman,
Michael R. Gordon
and Josh Dawsey

ritorial concessions to Russia and drop demands for a peacekeeping force to deter

future attacks by Moscow, U.S. officials said, resurfacing ideas that Kyiv has already rejected.

The administration is attempting the same approach it used to achieve a U.S.-brokered cease-fire in Gaza in October—draft a multipoint outline and then push the warring parties to accept it, officials said.

But the blueprint, which was worked out by U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio, special envoy Steve Witkoff and Trump son-in-law Jared Kushner in consultation with Kremlin confidant Kirill Dmitriev, is likely to run into strong opposition in Kyiv and from European governments,

a European official said.

President Trump supports the new plan, which materialized after he told aides to craft new proposals that include incentives for the two sides to reach a deal, officials said. The U.S. is counting on Russia's desire for revived economic relations with the West and Ukraine's need for reconstruction funds to catalyze an agreement.

Trump's yearlong effort to broker a deal to end the war hasn't yielded results. He held a summit with President Vladimir Putin of Russia in Alaska and multiple meetings with President Volodymyr Zelensky

of Ukraine. Zelensky has expressed willingness to pause the war to start negotiations, while Putin has issued maximalist demands that have irritated Trump and his aides.

On Wednesday, Trump again lamented that his relationship with Putin hadn't led to a swiftly brokered deal. Trump, a Republican, had promised during the 2024 presidential campaign to negotiate such a deal within 24 hours of his return to the White House.

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◆ **Ukraine attacks Russia** with U.S. missiles..... **A8**

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Trading jet lag for sea days on a 14-night cruise from Rome to New York. **A11**



BUSINESS & FINANCE
Target to invest billions to upgrade stores as sales slump persists. **B1**

Legacy of Mass Graves Haunts Syria's New Leaders

Nearly a year after Assad's fall, Syrians continue to unearth more burial sites and evidence of brutal killings

By JARED MALSIN AND HAMZA BONDUK

IZRAA, Syria—Early one morning last December, Dr. Mamdouh Zoubi drove to a farm on the edge of this small town in southern Syria to collect the bodies in a newly found mass grave, one of more than 100 turned up across the country.

The new owners of the farm, which had been sold days earlier, shortly after the fall of President Bashar al-Assad's regime, had stumbled across the bodies that morning and alerted Dr. Zoubi, who is one of the only forensic specialists in the area. The burial site,

now used as a tomato farm, was next to a military checkpoint that served for years as a base for Assad's soldiers.

By nightfall, rescue workers had found 31 bodies in various states of decay in a corner of the farm. The bodies had been layered on top of one another, suggesting multiple rounds of burial over several years, confirming the fears of the doctor and others in the town who suspected the local regime commander had been dumping the remains of the disappeared.

"We found exactly what we expected, a

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Austin 'Dazed' by School Loss

* * *
Locals aren't 'alright, alright, alright'

By ELIZABETH FINDELL

AUSTIN, Texas—When Dee Sullivan moved to Austin from South Carolina in 2011, one local landmark was top of her list to see: The school where "Dazed and Confused" was filmed.

She couldn't believe it when the building—Bedichek Middle School, in real life—was right down the street.

Her then-partner, Michael Barrera, attended Bedichek a few years after the release of the 1993 cult-classic coming-of-age film and grew up saying "Alright, alright, alright," a line immortalized by a young Matthew McConaughey

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Ex-FBI Agents Tracked Spy: 'I Think I Got Him'

By ROBERT McMILLAN

In July, Eric Kerr hung up after an eight-minute video call with a software developer and called up his former partner at the Federal Bureau of Investigation.

"I think I got him," he said. Kerr, a cybersecurity researcher, left the FBI in 2023, but there was one investigation he and his former co-investigator, Caleb Marquis, couldn't abandon.

On May 4, 2021, a hacker who went by the name Hades locked up servers at a Chantute, Kan., hospital during a ransomware attack. Hades was part of a crew of North Koreans who had burrowed in and disabled the hospital's corporate network. They had even shut down a computer in the sleep lab. The ransomware they used was something the FBI had never seen before.

The FBI has said the ransomware, known as Maui,

was built by North Korean hackers to make money for an espionage operation that eventually resulted in intrusions at the National Aeronautics and Space Administration, two U.S. Air Force bases and a handful of military contractors.

The hackers' mission was to steal military and technology secrets. To pay their living expenses as they did their work, they received more than \$500,000 in ransomware payments, federal prosecutors alleged in documents released in 2022.

On Wednesday, Kerr and Marquis, who has also left the bureau and works as a cybersecurity researcher, presented their evidence at a conference in Washington, D.C. Hades didn't return messages seeking comment.

Hades, identified as Conspirator 1 in a court filing, posted a note on the systems

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ORACLE
Fusion Applications

Just launched: AI Agent Studio

Easily create and deploy AI agents—including with Oracle Fusion Cloud Applications



Learn more
[Oracle.com/Fusion-AI](https://www.oracle.com/fusion-ai)